unpredictable, even fleeting things can often make a big difference in life.

Besides the debates, two other things stand out in my memory from the 1984 campaign. One was the enthusiasm of the blue-collar workers—voters traditionally allied with my former associates in the Democratic Party—that I met while stumping the country that summer and fall. While Walter Mondale and Ted Kennedy and Tip O'Neill were forever harping that I was the "rich man's candidate," everywhere I went crowds of working men and working women roared with approval when I asked them whether they thought they were better off than they had been four years earlier; the country was moving again, and they were sharing in the fruits of the economic recovery.

Another thing I will always remember: an outpouring of affection and support from college and university students I never expected. Although there were always a few hecklers on the campuses I visited, they were usually outnumbered by students enthusiastically cheering the policies of the previous four years, and this really took me by surprise: These students in the eighties seemed so different from those that I'd dealt with as governor a decade earlier.

Two days after the Kansas City debate, following a busy schedule of campaigning that began at the University of Oregon and ended with a giant rally on the campus of Ohio State University, I wrote in the diary: "The O.S.U. students were on fire; another small heckler group only added to the fun. By this time I was so in love with young America I was all choked up. For lunch we went to the T.K.E. house, my fraternity. These have been the greatest four days I can remember."

As election day approached, our campaign polls showed that following the second debate I had increased my lead over Mondale substantially. But I was still edgy. What happens, I thought, if my supporters read the polls and